

Milestone 2:

Storyboard and Mock-ups

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Course: DSC640

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PROJECT STORY

Help working parents understand how weekly, full-time childcare prices change by child age and differ by location; then encourage data-informed advocacy for employer flexibility and childcare support.

PLANNED MEDIUMS

01

Interactive Dashboard

Custom web dashboard; HTML, CSS, and JavaScript.

02

One-Page Infographic

Shareable summary for quick understanding and advocacy.

03

Short Explainer Presentation

6 to 8 slides for a short talk or internal share-out.

HOW THE THREE MEDIUMS WORK TOGETHER

Dashboard

Lets parents explore location, age group, provider type, and yearly trend.

Infographic

Summarizes the main findings into a fast, printable overview.

Presentation

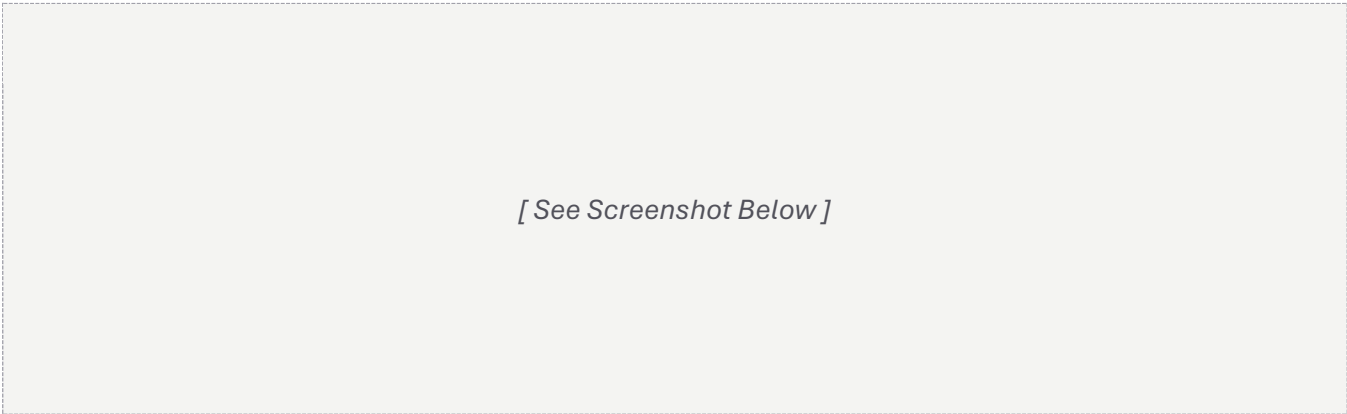
Turns the findings into a short persuasive story with a call to action.

MEDIUM 1

Interactive Dashboard

Format: Interactive Web Dashboard Mock-up	Build: HTML, CSS, and JavaScript Only
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STORYBOARD / MOCK-UP



NARRATIVE

AUDIENCE

Working parents with children age 10 or younger who want a fast answer about weekly childcare cost where they live.

PLAN

Build a parent-friendly dashboard that answers one question quickly: How much does full-time childcare cost per week in my area, and how does that change by child age? Filters lead into a location view, an age-group comparison, and a time trend. A key number card keeps the selected weekly price visible at all times.

MESSAGE

Infant and toddler care carry the highest weekly prices. Center-based care tends to cost more than family childcare, and county differences are large enough to affect work and budgeting decisions.

CALL TO ACTION

Use dashboard output when talking with employers or local leaders about flexibility, dependent-care benefits, or childcare support programs.

BUILD NOTES

Include unit labels, note when a selected value is imputed, and keep interactions simple enough for non-technical users. Optional affordability context can use county MHI if clearly labeled.

FILTERS INCLUDED

State · County · Year · Provider type · Age group · Price view · Imputation note toggle

Childcare Prices Dashboard (Mockup)

Weekly, full-time childcare prices. Placeholder values for Milestone 2 planning only.

Audience: Working parents

Goal: Clarify cost differences by age, provider type, and location

Call to action: Will use local numbers to advocate for support

Filters

Choose a county and compare costs

County

Jefferson County, AL

Provider type

Center-based

Percentile

Median

Age group focus

Infant (0-23m)

Mock note: In the final dashboard, these filters will drive real charts built from the dataset.

Selected weekly price

\$288

Center-based • Median • Infant (0-23m)

Monthly estimate

\$1,247

Weekly x 4.33

County median household income (context)

\$60,000

County-level context

Cost share of weekly income (proxy)

25%

Price ÷ (MHI/52)

Location

Map placeholder for Milestone 2

Jefferson County, AL

Map (mock)

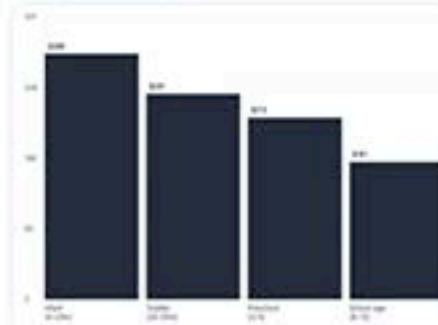
Click county shapes later

Jefferson County, AL

Replace with a real county map later (Tableau/Power BI or a JS map library). I'll decide later. For Milestone 2, this just shows layout and intent.

Price by age group

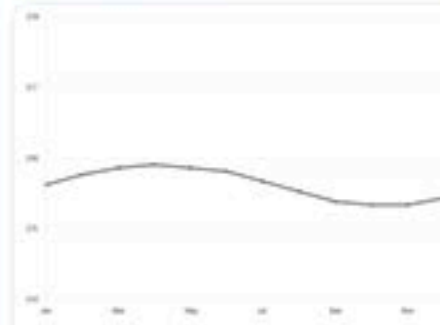
Weekly prices across ages



Design intent: make the age step-down obvious (infant → school-age).

Trend over time

Simple time view for context



Final version can use real years/quarters if available.

Interpretation panel

Plain-language explanation for working parents

- You selected Jefferson County, AL. The weekly, full-time cost for Infant (0-23m) is about \$288 for Center-based care at the Median.
- Use the age chart to compare your current stage against what comes next.
- If the share-of-income estimate is high, the final story points users toward employer support and policy options.

Call to action (mock)

Bring your county's numbers to your employer (HR), school board, or local leaders to support childcare assistance, flexible schedules, and subsidy funding.

Data note (mock): Replace with dataset measures labeled as weekly, full-time.

MEDIUM 2

One-Page Infographic

Format: Printable PDF or Shareable Image	Build: Infographic layout with simplified chart forms
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STORYBOARD / MOCK-UP

Headline + Subhead + Source Line		Main claim · Weekly, full-time price	
Infant Age path graphic	Toddler Age path graphic	Preschool Age path graphic	School Age Age path graphic
Center vs. Family Child Care Center Family Side-by-side comparison showing provider type price differences.		Location Variation Small map or ranked top and bottom counties, shows why place matters.	
What this data misses + Call to Action; Slot availability, informal care, imputed values, and a clear ask for benefits, flexibility, or local childcare investment.			

NARRATIVE

AUDIENCE

Working parents who want a quick takeaway without clicking through an interactive tool.

PLAN

Create a one-page infographic showing how weekly childcare prices shift as a child grows. Begins with a headline and unit note, then moves into an age-path visual, a provider comparison, and a simple location section. The footer explains dataset limits and keeps the call to action visible.

CALL TO ACTION

Encourage parents to plan for the early-years cost spike and to share the infographic when asking for employer benefits, flexible schedules, or local childcare investment.

BUILD NOTES

Keep labels plain, avoid chart overload, and reserve the bottom band for limits such as slot availability, informal care, and imputed county values.

MESSAGE

The early years are the most expensive, provider type matters, and geography changes what families pay.

MEDIUM 3

Short Explainer Presentation

Format: 6 to 8 Slide Storyboard	Build: PowerPoint or slide deck with talk track
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STORYBOARD / MOCK-UP

01 Hook Why childcare prices matter	02 Dataset What the data measures	03 Age Costs Highest in early years	04 Geography Large county variation
05 Budget View Affordability example	06 Parent Actions Planning and advocacy	07 Employer Actions Benefits and flexibility	08 Limits + Link Limits and dashboard QR

Plain language throughout, define units early, mention imputation and dataset limits, end with dashboard link or QR code.

NARRATIVE

AUDIENCE

Working parents in a short workplace or community setting, plus HR partners who support family benefits.

PLAN

Short slide sequence moving from problem to action. Starts with why childcare prices matter, explains the dataset, shows patterns by age and geography, adds one affordability example, and closes with concrete actions for parents and employers. The final slide points viewers to the dashboard for detail.

MESSAGE

Childcare affordability acts as a work constraint, and the cost burden changes significantly by child age and by county.

CALL TO ACTION

Ask employers for flexibility and dependent-care support, and encourage local attention where prices are highest.

BUILD NOTES

Plain language, define weekly full-time price early, keep each slide to one takeaway, include a final limits slide so the persuasive message stays credible.